

alongside them and have the courtesy to say 'no', even if they secretly resent you.

If you need attention as an athlete, train some other time

During your players' practice time, the focus should necessarily be on them.

If you want to be the centre of attention and expect praise and ego boosts for simply doing your job, you're totally the wrong candidate for training with your players. You'd be better off with your own cronies to be in that zone of self-affirmation.

Training with one specific player alone

This practice can disrupt the dynamics in a team environment, unless, of course, a player is undergoing rehab or specific improvement programmes designed by the team. Favouritism may creep in, driven by self-serving motives on the coach's part.

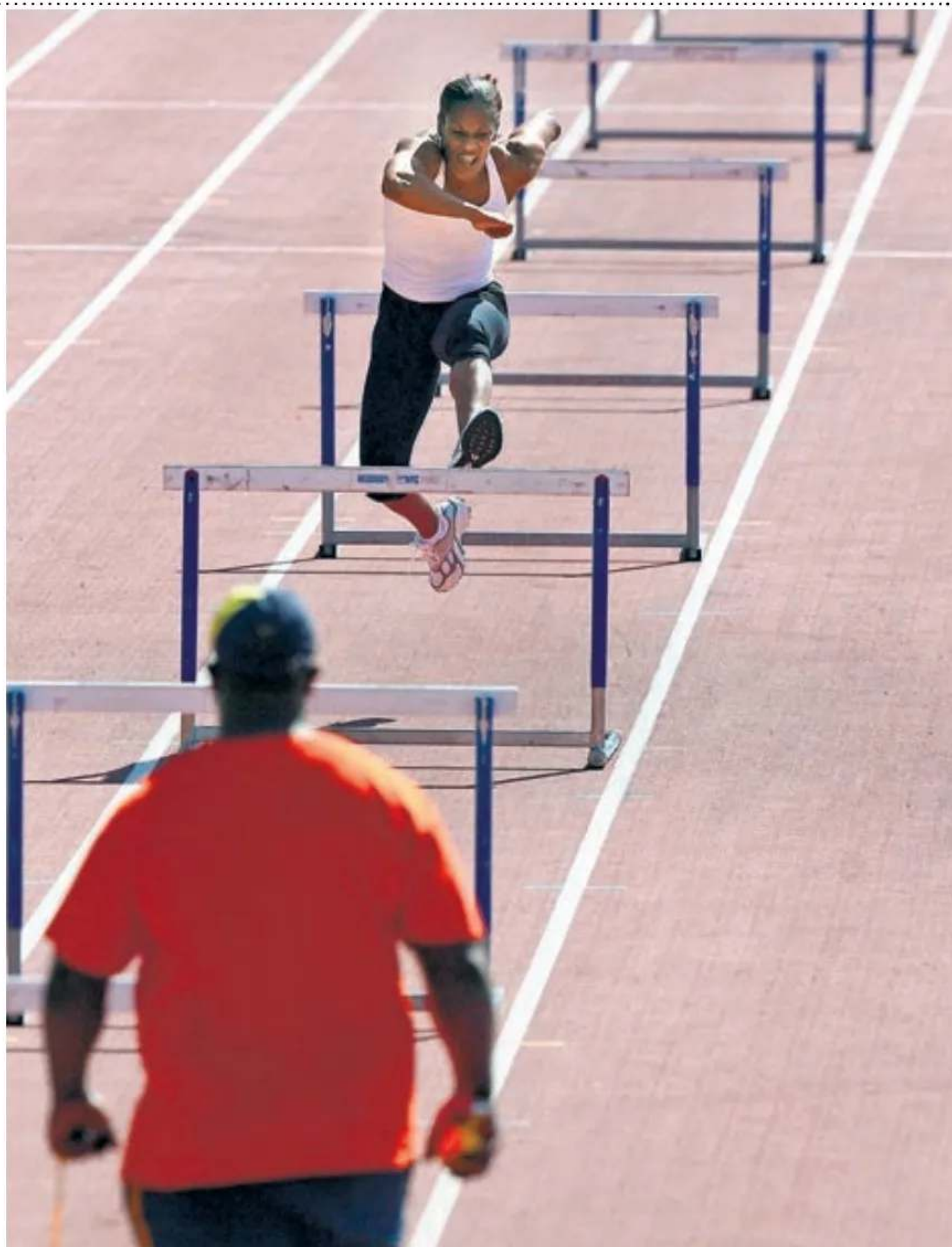
While individual training suits individual sports, it can be counterproductive within a team, creating rifts. It's important to have a professional approach to this methodology; otherwise, it can be perceived as a self-centred move by other players.

Using abusive language while training

This behaviour is a big no-no. Players may occasionally use harsh language, but that doesn't mean that coaches should follow suit. There's nothing fashionable or trend-worthy about this from a coaching perspective. Maintaining dignity, especially during a tough rep or set, will set a positive example for the players.

Keeping the workplace clean

All coaches must adhere to this etiquette. It is essential for them to maintain boundaries post-workout or after each set and keep things where they belong. This reflects the coach's self-discipline and commitment and serves as a powerful example for players to follow. No player should be too tired to maintain cleanliness after



Team comes first: While training with individual players may suit individual sports, it can be counterproductive within a team. GETTYIMAGES
a workout.

Working on the correct form

The most critical aspect of coaching is to lead by example and train players whenever required. One wrong move here can lead to a negative impact, spilling into subsequent sessions, and potentially becoming a setback for the coaches.

To sum it up, if you want to be a superior coach or even just play-act like one, you cannot be focused on your own workout while your players are training. You only get to work out when others aren't and when you're

not actively coaching someone. There are coaching ethics involved that need to be understood and designed according to the group's needs.

Ultimately, there will come a day when you have to decide if you're pretending to be an athlete or a coach. You can be both to some extent, but only one must be the unequivocal priority, and you'll have to accept the sacrifices in either case. The sooner you can figure this out, the better it is for your success.

'Always keep an open mind and a compassionate heart' — Phil Jackson.